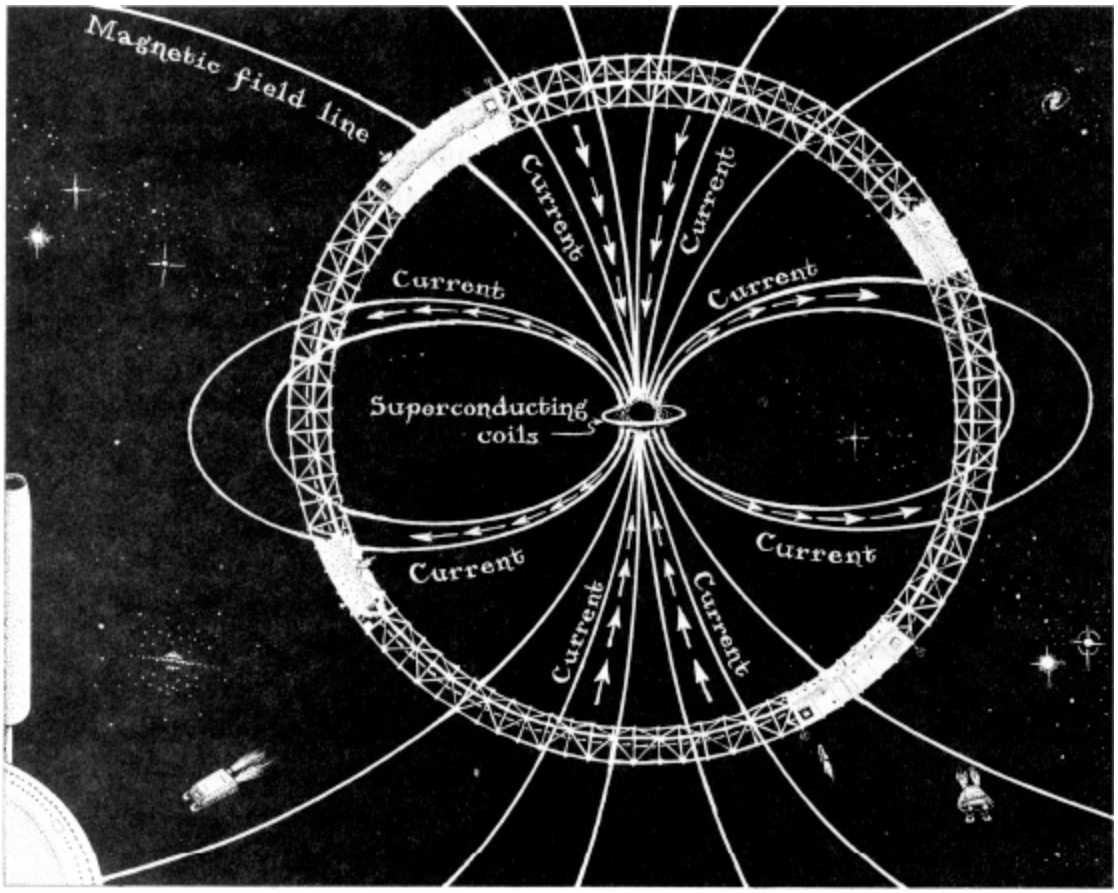


P.6 A city on a girder-work ring around a spinning black hole, and the electromagnetic system by which the city extracts power from the hole's spin.

Your crew and countless generations of their descendants can call this artificial world "home" and use it as a base for future explorations of the Universe. But not you. You long for the Earth and the friends whom you left behind, friends who must have been dead now for more than 4 billion years. Your longing is so great that you are willing to risk the last quarter of your normal, 200-year life span in a dangerous and perhaps foolhardy attempt to return to the idyllic era of your youth.

Time travel into the future is rather easy, as your voyage among the holes has shown. Not so travel into the past. In fact, such travel might be completely forbidden by the fundamental laws of physics. However, DAWN tells you of speculations, dating back to the twentieth century, that backward time travel might be achieved with the aid of a hypothetical space